

Everything you've typed so far

Every command, meta-command, and function actually used hands-on across this project — grouped by tool, in the order you met them, not alphabetized. Appended at the end of each build, not written once and frozen.

COVERS

Build 1 (agent), Build 2 (pipeline), Build 2.5 (scratch workspace) & Build 3 (semantic search) — all complete

ENVIRONMENT

Windows 11 · PowerShell · Docker Desktop

DATABASES

pg_local (appdb)



Docker

CONTAINER ORCHESTRATION

Starting the stack, and getting SQL in and out of a running container.

```
docker compose up -d --build
```

Build images if anything changed, then start every service in the background.

```
docker ps
```

List running containers — the first check when a connection unexpectedly fails.

```
docker exec -it pg_local psql -U devuser -d appdb
```

Open a **live, interactive** psql session inside the Postgres container.

```
Get-Content file.sql -Raw | docker exec -i pg_local psql -U devuser -d appdb
```

Run a whole .sql file inside the container **non-interactively**, PowerShell-style — < redirection doesn't exist in PowerShell, so the file gets piped in instead. (Bash/cmd would use `docker exec -i ... < file.sql`.)

```
docker compose down -v
```

Stop everything and delete volumes too — next start re-initializes DB passwords from .env. Used deliberately, not casually.

psql

META-COMMANDS & DDL PATTERNS

Once you're inside a psql session — both the backslash meta-commands and the recurring SQL shapes.

`\d table_name`

Describe a table — every column, its type, and any constraints. The one check that settles "did my CREATE TABLE actually work."

`\du role_name`

Describe a role — confirms it has no Superuser/Creatorole/Createdb it shouldn't.

`\pset null 'marker'`

Display NULLs as a visible marker instead of blank — otherwise a NULL and an empty string look identical.

`\! cls`

Shell out and run an OS command without leaving psql — `cls` clears the terminal screen.

`\q`

Quit psql, back to the shell prompt.

`CREATE SCHEMA IF NOT EXISTS name;`

Create a schema, skip quietly if it's already there — safe to rerun.

`DROP TABLE IF EXISTS name;`

Drop a table, skip quietly if it doesn't exist — what makes a rebuild script rerunnable from a blank database.

`GRANT SELECT ON ALL TABLES IN SCHEMA s TO role;`

Give a role read access to every table **currently** in a schema.

`ALTER DEFAULT PRIVILEGES IN SCHEMA s GRANT SELECT ON TABLES TO role;`

Extend that same grant automatically to any table created **later** — without this, new tables start private.

`col TYPE GENERATED ALWAYS AS (expr) STORED`

A column Postgres computes and locks from other columns in the same row — structurally impossible for it to drift out of sync.

`GRANT USAGE, CREATE ON SCHEMA s TO role;`

Let a role create objects inside a schema, not just read from it — how `appdb_agent_writer` got write access scoped to `agent_scratch` only, never anywhere wider.

`ALTER DEFAULT PRIVILEGES FOR ROLE owner IN SCHEMA s GRANT SELECT ON TABLES TO role;`

Extend a **different** role's read access to tables a specific owner role creates later in that schema — how `appdb_reader` can always see whatever `appdb_agent_writer` saves, without a re-grant each time.

`CREATE EXTENSION IF NOT EXISTS vector;`

Enable pgvector for the database — requires the `pgvector/pgvector` Postgres image, not the plain postgres one.

```
ALTER DATABASE db REFRESH COLLATION VERSION;
```

Clear the collation-version mismatch warning that appears after swapping to an image built against a different glibc/ICU — safe here since the data is plain ASCII text.

```
col vector(384)
```

pgvector's column type for a fixed-dimension embedding — 384 matches the sentence-transformers model in use, not an arbitrary choice.

```
a <=> b
```

Cosine distance between two vectors — smaller means more similar. What `search_summaries` orders by.

```
a <-> b
```

Euclidean (L2) distance between two vectors — used in this project only for the self-distance sanity check (`v <-> v` should be exactly 0).

```
vector_dims(col)
```

The dimensionality of a stored vector — a quick sanity check that every row actually has a real 384-dim embedding, not a malformed one.

```
CREATE INDEX ... USING hnsw (col  
vector_cosine_ops)
```

Build an approximate-nearest-neighbor graph index matching the `<=>` operator, so similarity search can use an index scan instead of a full table scan as the corpus grows.

```
EXPLAIN ANALYZE SELECT ...
```

Confirms whether the planner actually used a new index (Index Scan) or fell back to Seq Scan — the only real way to verify an index is doing anything.

PowerShell

HOST-SIDE SHELL

Running Python, checking your own environment, and vetting/installing system-level tools from outside any container.

```
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe script.py
```

Run a script with the project's own virtual-env interpreter directly — sidesteps PATH/activation issues entirely.

```
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe -m pip install pkg
```

Install a package into that specific virtual env, not wherever PATH happens to point.

```
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe -m pip show pkg
```

Check whether a package is installed, and exactly which version.

```
Get-ChildItem Env: | Where-Object { $_.Name -  
like "*X*" }
```

List environment variables whose name matches a pattern — e.g. catching a stray API key leaked into the shell.

```
Get-Content file
```

Print a file's contents — the go-to way to verify what actually got saved to disk.

```
claude auth status
```

Confirm this Claude Code session is on subscription login, not silently metered API billing.

```
winget show --id pkg -e
```

Pull a package's full manifest — publisher, source URL, license, install hash — before trusting or installing it.

```
winget install --id pkg -e
```

Install a package system-wide once it's been vetted, not before.

Committing at the end of every phase, per the project's own working style.

`git status`

What's changed, staged, or untracked, right now.

`git add file`

Stage a specific file by name — never a blind `-A`.

`git commit -m "... "`

Record the staged snapshot with a message explaining **why**, not just what.

`git mv old new`

Rename a tracked file while git keeps its history attached to the new name.

`git log --oneline -n`

Recent commit history, one line each — the fastest way to check "where are we, really."

`git diff`

Exact unstaged changes, line by line, before they get staged.

Python — psycopg

TALKING TO POSTGRES

The driver behind every script in this project — agent.py, tools.py, ingest.py, profile.py.

```
psycopg.connect(host=, dbname=, user=,  
password=)
```

Open a connection to a Postgres database.

```
with conn.cursor() as cur:
```

Open a cursor scoped to a with block — closes itself automatically, even on error.

```
cur.execute(sql, params)
```

Run one SQL statement, with parameters passed safely (never string-formatted into the query).

```
cur.executemany(sql, rows)
```

Run the same statement once per row — how ingest.py loads 1,535 rows in one call.

```
cur.fetchall()
```

Pull every result row back as a Python list.

```
cur.description
```

Metadata about the result's columns — used to grab column names generically.

```
conn.commit()
```

Make written changes permanent.

```
conn.close()
```

Release the connection.

Python — psycopg.sql

SAFE DYNAMIC IDENTIFIERS

save_dataframe's guardrail for building a CREATE TABLE/INSERT statement where the table and column names themselves come from the model, not just the values — %s parameters alone can't protect an identifier.

```
from psycopg import sql
```

The submodule that builds SQL safely out of parts psycopg can't treat as plain data — like table and column names.

```
sql.Identifier(name)
```

Safely quotes a dynamic identifier (table/column name) — the equivalent of a parameter, but for names instead of values.

```
sql.SQL(" ... {} ... ").format( ... )
```

Builds a SQL string from literal fragments plus safely-escaped pieces like Identifier — never plain f"..." string interpolation.

```
sql.SQL(", ").join(parts)
```

Joins a list of Identifier/SQL fragments with a separator — how a variable-length column list gets assembled.

```
sql.Placeholder()
```

A %s value placeholder built the same composable way, for when the number of columns isn't known until runtime.

Python — pandas

PROFILING RAW DATA

Everything profile_raw_data.py used to understand raw.allocations before designing the clean schema. (Renamed from profile.py in Build 3 — it was silently shadowing Python's stdlib profile module.)

```
pd.DataFrame(rows, columns=cols)
```

Build a DataFrame straight from plain rows + column names — no SQLAlchemy required.

```
df["col"].unique()
```

Every distinct value in a column, once each — printed with repr() to expose hidden whitespace.

```
df["col"].value_counts(dropna=False)
```

Count of each distinct value, including blanks/NaN.

```
pd.to_datetime(s, format=, errors="coerce")
```

Parse a column of date strings against an exact format; anything that doesn't match becomes NaT instead of crashing the run.

```
series.dt.total_seconds()
```

Convert a time difference into a plain number of seconds.

```
series.str.fullmatch(pattern)
```

Test every value in a column against a regex at once — used to confirm two columns were digit-only.

Python — pandera

DATA-QUALITY SCHEMAS

test_data_quality.py uses this to declare what "correct" looks like for clean.allocations, as data instead of ad hoc checks.

```
import pandera.pandas as pa
```

The explicit pandas-backend import for modern pandera versions.

```
pa.DataFrameSchema({ ... })
```

Declare an entire DataFrame's expected shape — one entry per column — as data, not scattered asserts.

```
pa.Column(type, checks, nullable=)
```

One column's expected type, whether NULLs are allowed, and any constraints.

```
pa.Check.ge(0)
```

A reusable constraint — here, "greater than or equal to 0" — attached to a Column.

```
schema.validate(df)
```

Check a real DataFrame against the schema; raises a real error the moment something doesn't match.

pytest

RUNNING THE TEST SUITE

First automated test suite in the project — codifies checks that were previously done by hand.

```
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe -m pytest -v
```

Discover and run every test_* function in the project, printing each one's name and pass/fail individually.

```
def test_something():
```

Any function named test_... in a test_*.py file is auto-discovered — no registration needed.

```
assert condition
```

Plain Python assert — pytest reports exactly which assertion failed and the actual vs. expected values.

```
with pytest.raises(ExceptionType):
```

Asserts a block **must** raise a specific exception — used to prove a role boundary actually blocks a write, not just that it "seems fine."

```
def test_x(monkeypatch):  
monkeypatch.setattr(mod, "NAME", val)
```

Temporarily overrides a module-level constant for one test only, auto-restored after — how a cap like MAX_SCRATCH_TABLES gets tested at its boundary without creating 50 real tables.

pgvector & embeddings

SENTENCE-TRANSFORMERS · PGVECTOR.PSYCOPG

Turning free text into vectors and getting Postgres to store/compare them —
embed_summaries.py, search_summaries.py, tools.py's
search_summaries.

```
from sentence_transformers import  
SentenceTransformer
```

A local, free embedding model library — no API key or per-call cost, unlike Voyage AI/OpenAI embeddings.

```
SentenceTransformer("all-MiniLM-L6-v2")
```

Loads the specific 384-dim model used throughout this project — first call downloads and caches it locally.

```
model.encode(text_or_texts,  
show_progress_bar=True)
```

Turns one string or a list of strings into embedding vector(s) — a progress bar matters when embedding 1,500+ rows at once.

```
from pgvector.psycopg import register_vector
```

Teaches a psycopg connection how to send/receive pgvector's vector type directly as numpy-like arrays, instead of raw strings.

```
register_vector(conn)
```

Applies that registration to a specific connection — needed once per connection, before any vector query runs.

```
cur.execute(" ... WHERE col ⇔ %s < %s ... ",  
(embedding, threshold))
```

Passes a computed embedding straight in as a query parameter — the distance operator and the threshold cutoff both happen inside the SQL, not in Python after fetching everything.

Python — standard library

CSV · OS · DOTENV

No extra install required — these ship with Python itself, or python-dotenv.

`csv.DictReader(f)`

Read a CSV where each row comes back as a `{column: value}` dict — chosen over pandas for ingestion specifically so nothing gets silently type-coerced.

`open(path, newline="", encoding="utf-8-sig")`

Open a file safely for CSV reading, transparently stripping a leading BOM if present.

`os.environ["KEY"]`

Read a required env var — raises immediately if it's missing, rather than continuing with a silent gap.

`os.environ.get("KEY", default)`

Read an optional env var, falling back to a default (e.g. `POSTGRES_HOST` defaulting to `127.0.0.1` outside Docker).

`load_dotenv(encoding="utf-8-sig")`

Load `.env` into the process environment — BOM-safe, matching how Windows tools often save that file.

Living document — appended at the end of each build, not written once and frozen. Reflects hands-on usage through Build 3, including its follow-up hardening pass (idempotent re-embedding, HNSW index) — all complete. Not exhaustive documentation for any of these tools, just what's actually been typed in this project so far.